

Connecticut State Department of Education

DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2023–24



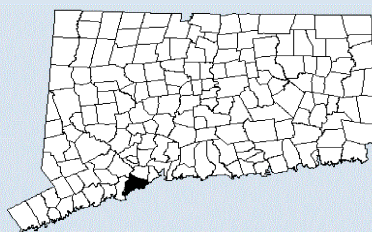
Milford School District

Anna Cutaia, Superintendent • 203-783-3402 • www.milforded.org/

District Information

Grade Range	PK-12
Number of Schools/Programs	16
Enrollment	5,327
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$24,217
Total Expenditures ¹	\$133,050,522

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2022-23 school year.



Community Information

AdvanceCT Town Profiles provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities at <https://www.advancect.org/site-selection/town-profiles>

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Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2023-24 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality. Complete data suppression guidelines are available at <https://tinyurl.com/SuppressionPolicy>

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2023 Enrollment²

	District		State
	Count	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Female	*	*	48.3
Male	2,730	51.2	51.5
Non-Binary	*	*	0.1
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	0.2
Asian	447	8.4	5.2
Black or African American	268	5.0	12.5
Hispanic or Latino of any race	868	16.3	31.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	0.1
Two or More Races	270	5.1	4.7
White	3,466	65.1	46.2
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	155	2.9	10.5
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	1,600	30.0	44.0
Students with Disabilities ³	958	18.0	17.9

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	400	16.1	76	2.8
Male	*	*	164	5.8
Non-Binary	*	*	0	*
Black or African American	36	13.9	24	8.6
Hispanic or Latino of any race	182	21.4	67	7.3
White	446	13.5	123	3.5
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	31	18.6	7	3.9
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	361	23.2	139	7.8
Students with Disabilities	244	25.1	82	7.3
District	767	15.1	240	4.4
State		17.7		7.0

Number of students qualified as truant under state statute: 1,057

Number of school-based arrests: 0

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

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Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	408.3
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	26.7
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	76.1
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	131.3
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	22.7
School Level	33.0
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	13.0
Support Staff	1.0
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	45.7
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	51.5
School Nurses	17.0
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	338.8

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	1	0.2	0.1
Asian	1	0.2	1.4
Black or African American	8	1.2	4.8
Hispanic or Latino of any race	3	0.5	5.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	0	0.0	0.3
White	643	98.0	88.3

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2022-23

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	13.0	13.3

Instruction and Resources

11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School²

	11th		12th	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Black or African American	9	*	27	96.4
Hispanic or Latino of any race	48	77.4	57	87.7
White	241	89.9	287	94.4
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	*	*	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	100	78.7	132	92.3
Students with Disabilities	37	62.7	93	87.7
District	342	86.4	425	93.8
State		88.4		94.6

² College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual credit courses.

Students Who Spend 80% or Greater Time with Nondisabled Peers³

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	49	38.3
Emotional Disability	24	41.4
Intellectual Disability	*	*
Learning Disability	242	83.7
Other Health Impairment	155	75.6
Other Disabilities	*	*
Speech/Language Impairment	116	87.2
District	603	69.1
State		66.8

³ This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

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Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	143	2.7	2.6
Emotional Disability	58	1.1	1.1
Intellectual Disability	19	0.4	0.6
Learning Disability	289	5.5	6.4
Other Health Impairment	206	3.9	3.5
Other Disabilities	58	1.1	1.2
Speech/Language Impairment	153	2.9	2.0
All Disabilities	926	17.7	17.3

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	28	3.0	8.0
Private Schools or Other Settings	66	7.1	4.6

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2022-23

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$93,138,549	\$16,953	\$12,942
Support services - students	\$3,936,240	\$739	\$1,724
Support services - instruction	\$1,736,903	\$326	\$905
Support services - general administration	\$2,701,590	\$507	\$520
Support services - school based administration	\$10,986,037	\$2,063	\$1,207
Central and other support services	\$241,634	\$45	\$771
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$11,732,258	\$2,203	\$2,101
Student transportation services	\$6,407,855	\$1,586	\$1,582
Food services	\$677,811	\$127	\$8
Enterprise operations	\$1,491,644	\$280	\$213
Total	\$133,050,522	\$24,217	\$21,143

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2022-23

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$10,210,813	30.8	27.6
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$3,421,245	10.3	10.2
Other Salaries	\$1,722,078	5.2	10.5
Employee Benefits	\$5,926,786	17.9	13.2
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$665,343	2.0	6.4
Special Education Tuition	\$7,960,203	24.0	22.2
Supplies	\$139,443	0.4	0.7
Property Services	\$2,208	0.0	0.4
Purchased Services For Transportation	\$3,013,856	9.1	8.4
Equipment	\$30,697	0.1	0.3
All Other Expenditures	\$27,433	0.1	0.1
Total	\$33,120,106	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		24.9	25.0

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2022-23

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	87.5
State	8.6
Federal	3.9
Tuition & Other	0.1

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

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Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

	English Language Arts (ELA)		Math		Science	
	Count	DPI	Count	DPI	Count	DPI
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	*	*	*	*
Asian	213	72.5	213	72.4	104	64.1
Black or African American	127	59.9	127	54.5	53	56.9
Hispanic or Latino of any race	442	61.6	442	57.5	195	57.5
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	*	*	*	*
Two or More Races	131	71.3	131	68.2	48	67.2
White	1,677	69.2	1,669	66.5	713	64.1
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	110	60.4	110	59.8	41	57.0
Non-English Learners/Non-Multilingual Learners	2,485	68.1	2,477	65.1	1,076	62.9
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	788	62.0	786	57.7	344	57.3
Not Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	1,807	70.3	1,801	68.1	773	65.1
Students with Disabilities	480	49.8	477	45.8	192	46.3
Students without Disabilities	2,115	71.9	2,110	69.2	925	66.1
High Needs	1,105	59.7	1,101	55.8	468	55.0
Non-High Needs	1,490	73.8	1,486	71.6	649	68.2
District	2,595	67.8	2,587	64.9	1,117	62.7

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

	NAEP 2022		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
READING			
Connecticut	35	35	50
National Public	32	29	36
MATH			
Connecticut	37	30	32
National Public	35	26	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2022.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard²

	Percent of Students by Grade ³ (%)				All Tested Grades	
	4	6	8	HS	Count	Rate (%)
Sit & Reach	71.3	73.7	76.2	91.3	1,538	78.1
Curl Up	77.8	87.6	89.1	95.2	1,538	87.5
Push Up	72.9	79.2	77.0	92.3	1,536	80.3
Mile Run/PACER	72.3	68.7	56.9	75.8	1,517	68.2
All Tests - District	44.8	50.8	46.3	69.7	1,506	52.7
All Tests - State	53.6	48.4	44.6	42.3		47.2

²The Connecticut Physical Fitness Assessment (CPFA) is administered to students in Grades 4, 6, 8 and High School (HS). The health-related fitness scores gathered through the CPFA should be used to educate and motivate children and their families to increase physical activity and develop lifetime fitness habits.

³Only students assessed in all four areas are included in this calculation.

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Cohort Graduation: Four-Year¹

	2022-23	
	Cohort Count ²	Rate (%)
Black or African American	21	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	62	88.7
White	308	90.9
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	153	88.2
Students with Disabilities	64	73.4
District	428	91.4
State		88.4

¹ The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

² Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2022-23 school year.

11th and 12th Graders Demonstrating Postsecondary Readiness³

	Count	Rate (%)
Female	212	50.0
Male	197	46.4
Non-Binary	N/A	N/A
Black or African American	12	27.9
Hispanic or Latino	45	35.4
White	284	49.7
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	88	32.6
Students with Disabilities	20	12.1
District	409	48.2
State		44.3

³Students demonstrate postsecondary readiness through at least one of the following:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam
- Earning three or more non-remedial college credits cumulatively during high school.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

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ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

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IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

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College Entrance and Persistence

	Class of 2023	Class of 2022
	Entrance ⁵ Rate (%)	Persistence ⁶ Rate (%)
Female	80.4	95.4
Male	67.0	91.6
Non-Binary	N/A	N/A
Black or African American	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	57.9	84.4
White	75.3	96.6
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	63.9	88.1
Students with Disabilities	36.2	85.7
District	73.6	93.8
State	68.4	87.2

⁵ College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

⁶ College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

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Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	Points Earned	Max Points	% Points Earned	State Average Index/Rate
ELA Performance Index	All Students	67.8	75	45.2	50	90.4	63.9
	High Needs Students	59.7	75	39.8	50	79.6	54.1
Math Performance Index	All Students	64.9	75	43.3	50	86.6	60.2
	High Needs Students	55.8	75	37.2	50	74.4	49.5
Science Performance Index	All Students	62.7	75	41.8	50	83.6	61.8
	High Needs Students	55.0	75	36.7	50	73.4	51.4
ELA Academic Growth	All Students	63.4%	100%	63.4	100	63.4	58.7%
	High Needs Students	59.4%	100%	59.4	100	59.4	54.2%
Math Academic Growth	All Students	69.7%	100%	69.7	100	69.7	61.4%
	High Needs Students	63.2%	100%	63.2	100	63.2	55.1%
Progress Toward English Proficiency	Literacy	70.9%	100%	35.4	50	70.9	58.9%
	Oral	66.2%	100%	33.1	50	66.2	55.2%
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	15.1%	<=5%	29.9	50	59.8	17.7%
	High Needs Students	22.6%	<=5%	14.8	50	29.6	25.5%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	90.3%	75%	50.0	50	100.0	91.5%
	% Meeting Benchmark	48.2%	75%	32.1	50	64.2	44.3%
On-track to High School Graduation		88.9%	94%	47.3	50	94.6	84.5%
4-year Graduation All Students (2023 Cohort)		91.4%	94%	97.2	100	97.2	88.4%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2021 Cohort)		90.0%	94%	95.7	100	95.7	86.6%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2023)		73.6%	75%	98.1	100	98.1	68.4%
Physical Fitness (estimated part rate) and (fitness rate)		94.7% 52.7%	75%	35.1	50	70.3	93.6% 47.2%
Arts Access		50.8%	60%	42.3	50	84.7	55.0%
Accountability Index				1110.9	1450	76.6	

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Achievement Gap Size Outlier?					N
ELA Performance Index Gap	73.8	59.7	14.1	16.9	
Math Performance Index Gap	71.6	55.8	15.8	18.2	
Science Performance Index Gap	68.2	55.0	13.2	17.9	
Graduation Rate Gap	94.0%	90.0%	4.0%	9.9%	N

¹If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

²If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served. Gap calculations are based on unrounded rates.

Subject/Student Group		Participation Rate (%) ³
ELA	All Students	98.0
	High Needs Students	96.1
Math	All Students	97.7
	High Needs Students	95.8
Science	All Students	97.8
	High Needs Students	96.2

³Minimum participation standard is 95%.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

Grade 3 ELA Performance Index for Students with Disabilities:

District: 55.1

State: 49.7

Supporting Resources: <https://public-edsight.ct.gov/Overview/Next-Generation-Accountability-Dashboard#related-links>

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Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

In Milford Public Schools, we utilize a core set of four anchoring frameworks to guide, support, and sustain progress and growth across the district. The MPS model for High Quality Instruction (HQI), Vision of the Learner (VoL), Developmental Relationships Framework (DRF), and MPS Equity Framework work in support of the Board of Education's Goals and Commitments. A continued focus on ensuring a safe and supportive climate that promotes high-quality instructional experiences and opportunities for each student is central to our theory of action. Our district professional learning opportunities are intentionally aligned to the singular district improvement strategy of implementing high-quality instruction in every classroom for every student through embedded professional learning experiences for staff and leaders.

The district has continued to evolve its systems of support for learners. An extensive revision of our Multi-Tiered Systems of Support (MTSS) plan aligned to our school Student Assistance Team (SAT) and instructional coaching model are occurring at the elementary level. Building-based attendance and truancy teams work closely with families to support improvement in student attendance. Our strong transition program provides students ages 18-22 job-embedded work and life skill development experiences. The Parsons Perks coffee stand is one example of the excellence of this program. Our district-wide Social Emotional Learning Guiding Coalition focused on themes of belonging, building community in the classroom, and building community with families.

We continue to explore opportunities to strengthen school, family and community partnership across all levels, elementary, middle school and high school. The Pupil Personnel Department (PPS) continues to offer virtual and in-person IEP/504 meetings to review student progress towards meeting academic and social-emotional goals and objectives. Professional learning opportunities centered-around dyslexia support were available to staff. The Parent University workshops offered families across the district opportunities to learn about student wellness, college financial planning, and summer literacy opportunities. Weekly school-based newsletters continue to provide families with pertinent resources and information. In collaboration with the Milford Prevention Council, our high schools offered an opportunity for families to learn from experts on the influences teens face daily through our Freshmen Forum. Each of our fourteen campuses offers opportunities for families to become involved through PTA, PTO, Booster Clubs, or other parent groups. Families in our Ready to Learn (RTL) programs were introduced to the Sparkler application. This free program offered by the Connecticut State Office of Early Childhood Education supports families with engaging learning activities in the home environment. The district hosted two Community Conversation events where families were able to hear from a panel of student and business leaders regarding the current and future school and workforce needs. The district administers an annual survey to all families regarding school climate and garners feedback on communication and programming. We continue to explore how to best leverage technology and social media platforms to share information with our MPS families and wider city community.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

Milford Public Schools continues to explore opportunities to reduce inequity and isolation across our district and in partnership with local organizations. Our Board of Education affirmed its commitment to advocating for equity and inclusivity through its support of the launch of our Equity Framework. This framework provides key direction in six key areas ranging from building authentic student relationships to developing staff capacity, and centering family engagement and voice.

Leading with the research that demonstrates the impact of student achievement that can result from a diverse educator workforce, the district established a working group to develop a plan to increase educator diversity. This work began with our commitment to "being an inclusive, nurturing, equitable and anti-racist learning environment, where every student, teacher, support professional, parent and school community member is treated with dignity and respect."

Our schools remain committed to a variety of programs, learning experiences, and opportunities for belonging and inclusivity. This included the Black Student Union, Asian Pacific Islander Club, Buddy Bench Program, and Gay-Straight Alliance. At the middle school level, we support students through the implementation of the Wingman program. The district continues to host students through the Open Choice program. Through revision of curriculum in ELA and Social Studies, students were provided with a wider range of diverse texts and that offered the opportunity to learn through multiple and diverse perspectives. Partnerships with local community organizations continue to reduce economic hardships for families. The YMCA and Boys and Girls Club ensured affordable before and after school childcare for families. The Salvation Army's Backpack Program continues to provide "new backpacks full of school supplies" for students in need. Partnership with Milford's Food to Kids provided nutritional resources to families. School counseling provided individualized FAFSA support for first generation college students. Fee waivers are provided to students receiving free and/or reduced lunch for SAT and Advanced Placement testing.

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Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

We continue to prioritize equitable distribution of resources across our fourteen campuses. Using a zero-based budgeting approach, our district budget represents the true need of every classroom, school, and district program. Budgets are developed utilizing the four district pillars as a foundation: Vision of the Learner, model for HQI, Developmental Relationships Framework, and MPS Equity Framework. Our school district supports access to technology for all learners through its 1:1 program. Our Information Systems Department continues to collaborate with the Teaching and Learning Department to ensure that families have resources and support to promote continued learning at home through the use of technology. Our staffing model includes a school counselor at each of our elementary schools to offer comprehensive school counseling and related support services for students and families. We are proud to support world language instruction beginning at the elementary level across all eight elementary schools. Our PK-8 instructional coaching model continues to support student and staff learning in support of the district model for High Quality Instruction.